Weak Jump Overcalls

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Weak Jump Overcalls are preemptive jump overcalls intended to obstruct the opponents' bidding. A weak jump overcall typically promises:

- a 6-card suit at the 2-level (identical to a Weak Two opening bid)
- a 7-card suit at the 3-level

These guidelines are subject to partnership agreement and vulnerability. Aggressive pairs may preempt with shorter suits, especially when not vulnerable.

A weak jump overcall shows 5-10 high card points, although vulnerability too is a consideration. For instance, it may be advisable to pass rather than preempt at unfavorable vulnerability with only 5 points.

♠T92 ♥5 ♦AKT982 ♣J32	West Pass	North Pass	East 1♣	South 2♦ [1]

[1] A weak jump overcall, showing 5-10 points and 6 diamonds.

♠T985432 ♥K5 ♦Q92 ♣6	West 1♣	North Pass	East 1♥	South 2♠ [1]

[1] A two-level preempt can be made with a bad 7-card suit and minimum strength, especially at unfavorable vulnerability.

♠5 ♥KJT9732 ♦A2 ♣J32	West 1♦	North Pass	East 1♠	South 3♥ [1]

[1] Showing 5-10 points and a 7-card heart suit.

Responses to a Weak Jump Overcall

Response	Meaning
A simple raise	Shows 3 or 4-card support and approximately 6-13 points (insufficient values for a game contract). It is preemptive and completely non-forcing.
A jump raise	Usually shows a weak, preemptive hand (with at least 4-card support). It is also common to make a 4♥/♠ jump raise with 5-card support regardless of strength. However, a major suit jump raise may also be made by a strong hand that believes the game contract will succeed.
A new suit	Natural and non-forcing, typically showing a 6-card suit and denying support for partner's suit.
2NT	Depends on partnership agreement. It can be played as natural and invitational to 3NT, or it can be played as an artificial force, showing any type of good hand. Overcaller can bid a side suit feature (i.e. an ace or king), or simply rebid his suit at the cheapest level.
A cuebid of an opposing suit	Usually played as a forcing raise with interest in game. With a minimum hand, overcaller can rebid his suit at the cheapest level. With a strong hand, overcaller can bid game or a side suit ace or king.

Example Responses

♠AJ3
♥52
♦T942
♣K542

West	North	East	You
1♥	2♠ [1]	Pass	3♠ [2]

[1] Weak.
[2] An obstructive 3-card raise. Non-forcing.

♠92
♥JT532
♦T9
♣AQT2

West	North	East	You
1♦	2♥ [1]	Pass	4♥ [2]

[1] Weak.
[2] A 5-card raise. Maybe it's a good sacrifice. Maybe partner might even make it.

♠AKJ932
♥AT3
♦T92
♣2

West	North	East	You
1♦	3♣ [1]	Pass	3♠ [2]

[1] Weak.
[2] Natural and non-forcing. Strongly implies a lack of club support.

♠AKJ2
♥KQJ5
♦6
♣K743

West	North	East	You
1♦	2♥ [1]	Pass	4♥ [2]

[1] Weak.
[2] A strong raise to game.